Toine Fiselier

Postdoctoral Researcher, ESSEC Business School, Cergy, France
toinefiselier@gmail.com — +31 (0)6 44613498
toinefiselier.github.io/ToineFiselier

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: democratic legitimacy, political support, polarization (ideological and affective), foreign influence and interference, elite cues and opinion formation, democratic resilience, political conflict, democratic erosion, political behaviour.

Methodological: causal inference, survey experiments, panel data analysis, public opinion research.

ACADEMIC & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

ESSEC Business School — Cergy, France
Postdoctoral Researcher, R-S3i Project — September 2026 — Present

- Two-year project on resilience to foreign influence, interference, and intimidation in European democracies, funded by CY Initiative. Supervisor: Professor Aurélien Colson.
- Day-to-day project coordination; research on a taxonomy of influence, interference, and intimidation, and on how citizens respond to foreign interference and elite cues.

European University Institute — Fiesole, Italy
PhD Researcher — September 2022 — August 2026

- Dissertation examines the intersection between polarization and political support, investigating under which conditions ideological and affective polarization are harmful or beneficial for democratic legitimacy.
- Supervisor: Professor Filip Kostelka

R-Evolve (HORIZON Funded Project) — Florence, Italy
External Advisor and Collaborator — March 2026 — Present

- Advised on survey design and data quality assessment (reliability, validity) for circular economy transition research; developed a Shiny app to support co-design workshops for consumer involvement and persona identification.

EUandI — Fiesole, Italy
Research Assistant — October 2024 — Present

- Data-cleaning and analyses using survey data collected from the EUandI voting advice application.

Wageningen University — Wageningen, The Netherlands
Research Visit — September 2024 — December 2024

- Participated in the Mobilization of Political Dissatisfaction project (NWO Vici grant), complementing dissertation research with project data.

SOLID (ERC Funded Project) — Fiesole, Italy
Research Coder — January 2024 — February 2024

- Coded Dutch newspaper articles for content analysis of party-issue relationships during electoral campaigns using a standardised coding framework.

Searching for Europe — Amsterdam/Utrecht, The Netherlands
Researcher — May 2023 — December 2023

- Fielded pre- and post-surveys to measure the impact of theatre shows disseminating knowledge about the EU; responsible for survey design and statistical analyses.

EDUCATION

European University Institute, Fiesole, Italy — September 2022 — Present
PhD in Political and Social Sciences (defense 2 November 2026)
Dissertation: *Beyond the Alarm: Three Perspectives on Polarization*
Supervisor: Professor Filip Kostelka

European University Institute, Fiesole, Italy — September 2022 — August 2023
Master of Research: Political and Social Science

Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands — September 2019 — July 2020
Master of Science: Comparative Politics
Thesis: *It's all 'bout the money: A thesis on the relation between changes in income and political support in the Netherlands.*

Methods: Panel data analysis

Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands September 2016 — July 2019
Bachelor of Science: Political Science
Thesis: *United in Exceptionalism: A Research on the French Strategy towards the EU's Cultural Diplomacy.*
Methods: Semi-structured interviews with policy-makers

HKU University of the Arts, Utrecht, The Netherlands September 2012 — July 2017
Bachelor of Arts: Music Management
Thesis: *Unnoticed absence: Career Development and representation of Female Artists.*
Methods: Semi-structured interviews with industry professionals

PUBLICATIONS

Articles

- Kostelka, F., Alberdi, M., Bradley, M., Fiselier, T., Jabbour, A., Mansour, N., Minaeva, E., Porciuleanu, S., & Rafailova, D. (2026). Mass attitudes towards Russia's aggression against Ukraine: Tentative support for top-down opinion formation. *European Journal of Political Research.* Advance online publication (First View), 1-26. doi:10.1017/S1475676526101352
- van Ham, C., Sipma, T., & Fiselier, T. (2025). Why Do Citizens Perceive Free and Fair Elections as Fraudulent? The Role of Elite and Media Information Cues. *Election Law Journal: Rules, Politics, and Policy. 24(2). doi.org/10.1089/elj.2024.0067*
- van Elsas, E., & Fiselier, T. (2023). Conflict or choice? The differential effects of elite incivility and ideological polarization on political support. *Acta Politica, 59(3). doi.org/10.1057/s41269-023-00288-5*

Working papers

- Fiselier, T. (Submitted to BJPolS, solo-authored). In Search of the Sweet Spot: Ideological Polarization, Representation, and Political Support.
- Fiselier, T., Mansour, N. & Kostelka, F. (In preparation). Dividing Differences: Identifying the Drivers Behind Affective Polarization in a Survey Experiment.
- Fiselier, T. (In preparation, solo-authored). Rethinking Affective Polarization: How Positive Partisan Feelings Boost Political Support.
- Zuffova, M., & Fiselier, T. (In preparation). Gendered Cost of Public Participation? A Systematic Review of VAWIP Literature (2006-2026).

Datasets

- Cicchi, L., Reiljan, A., Canalejo Molero, Á., Ferreira da Silva, F., Garzia, D., Trechsel, A.H., & Fiselier, T.A.G. (2026). *EU&I 2024 party and user dataset.* European University Institute. https://hdl.handle.net/1814/95154
- Fiselier, T. (2026). *Cheesy Correlations and Causality: A synthetic teaching dataset for social science statistics.* Available on request.

Policy reports

- Den Ridder, J., Fiselier, T. & van Ham, C. (2021). *Draagvlak voor het burgerforum. Een verkenning van de Nederlandse publieke opinie [translation: Support for a citizens' assembly: An exploration of the Dutch public opinion].* The Hague: Sociaal en Cultureel Planbureau. https://www.scp.nl/documenten/2021/11/04/draagvlak-voor-het-burgerforum
- van Ham, C. & Fiselier, T. (2021). *Vertrouwen in eerlijke verkiezingen [translation: Trust in electoral integrity].* The Hague: De Kiesraad/The Dutch Electoral Council.
https://www.kiesraad.nl/documenten/2022/2/3/vertrouwen-in-eerlijke-verkiezingen

GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Early Stage Researcher Fund European University Institute, Florence, Italy
Total value: €2,000 November 2024

- To field a survey experiment.

EUI Scholarship NUFFIC, The Hague, The Netherlands
Total value: €147,093.20 September 2022

- Consisting of €62,400 tuition fees and €84,693.20 living scholarship.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Cheesy Correlations and Causality Florence, Italy
Development and Design April 2026 — Present

- Developed a statistics teaching module for social science courses, based on a fictional cheese market dataset covering bachelor-to-master level analyses. Includes a teaching manual with hypotheses and coded examples in R, Stata, and SPSS. Dataset available on request.

Jouw Scriptiecoach Santpoort-Noord, The Netherlands
Thesis Coach June 2024 — Present

- Individualised thesis coaching for students in Political Science, Psychology, Medicine, Communication Science, Economics, and Business Administration, covering research design, statistical analyses, and academic writing.

Radboud University Nijmegen, The Netherlands
Teaching and Research Assistant September 2020 — July 2022

- Teaching assistant for the following courses:
  - International Political Economy
  - Current Debates in International Political Economy
  - Political Science Research Methods
  - Project 1: Explanations for political attitudes and behavior in the Netherlands
  - Project 3: Comparative Governance
  - Sociology, Philosophy, and Ethics of Research
  - Bachelor Thesis supervision
- Assisted in writing policy reports for the Dutch Electoral Council and the Netherlands Institute for Social Research.

CONFERENCES, WORKSHOPS, PRESENTATIONS, AND SUMMER SCHOOLS

Politicologenetmaal Universiteit Gent, Ghent, Belgium
Presentation at the Polarization Panel during the Dutch and Flemish political science conference June 10-11, 2026

DVPW: Citizen's trust and societal polarization Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany
Presented at the Dynamic interrelations between political trust and political parties panel. March 27-28, 2025

Consequences of Political Polarization Workshop Masaryk University, Brno, Czech Republic
Presented working paper during one of the panels. December 16, 2024

PolSci Lunch Lectures Series Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands
Presented working paper for students and staff. December 27, 2024

Affective Depolarization Workshop European University Institute, Fiesole, Italy
Presented at the Affective polarization and democratic backsliding panel. June 27-28, 2024

Radboud Summer School Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands
Courses on Structural Equation Modeling and missing data. June 19-23, 2023

International Cultural Relations Conference University of Rijeka, Rijeka, Croatia
Attended and participated in workshops. May 30-31, 2019

SKILLS

- **Methods:** Panel data analysis (fixed effects, hybrid/within-between models, asymmetrical models, cross-lagged panel models), survey experiments (vignette and conjoint designs), multilevel modeling, missing data techniques, structural equation modeling, semi-structured interviews, text-coding.
- **Statistical Software:** Stata (advanced — automation, publication-quality output), R (including Shiny applications), SPSS (intermediate), Excel (intermediate).
- **Research Tools:** Qualtrics (survey design and programming in Javascript), LaTeX/Overleaf.
- **Data:** Experience with large-scale surveys (British Election Study, LISS, EUandI), cross-national survey data, experimental data processing and analysis.

LANGUAGES

Dutch	Native speaker
English	C2
German	B2
Italian	B1

OTHER EXPERIENCES

RideLyrics Fiesole, Italy
Founder/Coder April 2026 — Present

- Development and coding of a Garmin app to display music lyrics on Garmin navigation devices.

Stichting/Foundation Walhalla Deventer, The Netherlands
Board Member November 2011 — February 2016

- Financial administration, PR and bookings for a youth centre.

Beeldenstormers Art Expo Deventer, The Netherlands
Co-organizer June 2015

- Co-founded and organised a month-long exposition for young local artists.

REFERENCES

Prof. Filip Kostelka
Professor in Political and Social Change and Director of Graduate Studies
European University Institute, Fiesole, Italy
E-mail: Filip.Kostelka@EUI.EU

Associate Prof. Saskia Ruth-Lovell
Associate Professor of Resilient Democracy
Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands
E-mail: Saskia.Ruth-Lovell@ru.nl

Associate Prof. Andrej Zaslove
Associate Professor of Comparative Politics
Radboud University, Nijmegen, The Netherlands
E-mail: Andrej.Zaslove@ru.nl